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Deputy Director, Mission and Corporate Delivery, Public Transport Strategy and Security Directorate

Department for Transport

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 28th June 2026



Department
for Transport

Reference number

466623

Salary

£86,000

£86,000 (pro rata for part time or Job Share)

For existing Civil Servants, internal candidates the usual pay rules should

apply, i.e. if moving on level transfer the salary will remain the same, if successful on promotion the salary will be the higher of either 10% pay increase or the pay band minimum.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

PTLG

Type of role

Senior leadership

Strategy

Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Birmingham, Leeds and London. Frequent travel to other sites may be required.

As a member of the SCS you will be leading teams working on a hybrid basis. The expectation is that you will spend over the 60% workplace attendance requirement of your time in the workplace. Some travel to other DfT workplaces may be required.

About the job

Job summary

Are you excited by the prospect of leading the transport elements of the Government's key commitments on safer streets and improving public health?

Step into a role at the heart of delivering safer, more inclusive, and healthier journeys for millions.

You will be joining a Deputy Director job share that will lead a high-impact portfolio, shaping personal safety across the transport network, driving forward a step change in women's safety on public transport, and championing transport's critical contribution to wider health outcomes.

This is a pivotal leadership position where strategic vision meets visible, real-world impact, ensuring that every passenger feels confident, protected, and supported when using public transport.

Alongside this, you will provide trusted leadership to the corporate support team for the Public Transport and Local Group, enabling effective delivery across a complex and high-profile agenda.

If you are motivated by making a tangible difference to people's everyday experiences and outcomes, this is an opportunity to lead change that truly matters.

Job description

Responsibilities

With a clear mission to deliver meaningful change for the travelling public, you will drive the Department's contribution to the Cross-Government Safer Streets Mission, championing personal safety and ensuring transport plays a leading role in tackling violence against women and girls and antisocial behaviour.

Key Responsibilities Include:

Leading and co-ordinating DfT's contribution to the cross-Whitehall Safer Streets Mission working closely with partners across government and the wider DfT family.

Driving forward a bold, outcomes-focused programme to reduce violence against women and girls and antisocial behaviour across all modes of transport.

Providing strategic oversight of personal safety initiatives spanning local transport (including buses, taxis and private hire), rail, roads and active travel

Overseeing delivery of high-impact programmes, including a significant Spending Review 2025 commitment to improve CCTV provision on buses.

Spearheading the development of innovative solutions, including proposals for a national reporting tool for crime and antisocial behaviour across the transport network.

Commissioning and shaping research to identify new opportunities to enhance safety and confidence for transport users.

Leading a dynamic external engagement and communications strategy, building strong partnerships with transport operators and local authorities to raise awareness, influence behaviour, and deliver tangible improvements on the ground.

Play a leading role in shaping how transport supports public health outcomes across government. You'll coordinate the Department's contribution to the Health Mission, working collaboratively with policy teams including the active travel policy team within DfT and Active Travel England, to ensure transport is a key driver in improving health and wellbeing nationwide. You'll also partner closely with departments such as

DHSC and MHCLG, helping to deliver a truly cross-government mission with real impact.

Head up the Public Transport Portfolio Office, playing a pivotal role at the heart of PTLG. This is a unique opportunity to shape how we deliver, support and continuously improve public transport policy and operations. Responsibilities in this area will include:

Lead strategic financial and resource management, providing expert business partnering to PTLG directorates to ensure effective planning, prioritisation and delivery.

Champion strong governance and risk management, guiding directorates to make confident, well-informed decisions.

Drive engagement across PTLG, building strong relationships and ensuring clear, consistent communication at all levels.

Oversee support to the DfT Policy Profession, helping to maintain high standards and professional excellence across the organisation.

Chair and lead the PTLG People Committee, shaping our people strategy, culture and capability.

Ensure robust management assurance and business continuity, keeping our operations resilient and future-ready.

Provide oversight of the Director General's Private Office, supporting effective leadership and decision-making at the highest level.

Play an active leadership role within the Public Transport Strategy and Security Senior Management Team, taking on leadership of corporate initiatives within the Directorate and Group as appropriate.

This is a high-impact leadership role for someone who thrives in a dynamic environment, enjoys working across complex portfolios, and is motivated by delivering meaningful outcomes for public transport.

Person specification

You will need to be able to show, through your application, that you have the professional skills, breadth of experience and personal qualities for

this post, as well as the leadership skills to succeed at Deputy Director level in the Senior Civil Service.

Inspirational senior leadership A proven ability to lead at a strategic level, with oversight of critical areas such as personal transport safety, health, transport policy, and corporate delivery. You'll shape direction, set ambition, and ensure delivery at scale within PTLG.

A track record of building and leading high-performing teams

Experience creating and nurturing multidisciplinary teams that thrive in complexity championing innovation, fostering collaboration, and confidently leading through change.

Outstanding stakeholder engagement skills A natural relationship builder who can work seamlessly across government, industry, and international partners bringing people together to deliver shared goals and impactful outcomes.

Exceptional communication and influencing skills The ability to distil complex technical and policy issues into clear, compelling narratives for Ministers and senior leaders, directly informing decision-making at the highest levels.

A passion for delivering strong corporate outcomes Commitment to creating an environment where colleagues can succeed ensuring senior leaders are equipped with the data, insights, and support they need to lead effectively and deliver excellent results.

Forward-thinking strategic vision Experience developing long-term strategies and delivery plans that anticipate and respond to emerging technological and societal changes ensuring the organisation is ready for the future.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £86,000, Department for Transport contributes £24,914 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

Whatever your role, we take your career and development seriously, and want to enable you to build a really successful career with the Department and wider Civil Service.

It is crucial that our employees have the right skills to develop their careers and meet the challenges ahead, and you'll benefit from regular performance and development reviews to ensure this development is ongoing. As a Civil Service employee, you'll be entitled to a large range of benefits.

Equality, Diversity & Inclusion

The Civil Service values and supports all its employees.

We have strong and pro-active staff networks, special leave policies for hospital appointments, reasonable adjustments put in place for those who need them, and diversity talent programmes to help everyone irrespective of background, to achieve their potential.

Pension

Your pension is a valuable part of your total reward package.

A competitive contributory pension scheme that you can enter as soon as you join where we will make a significant contribution to the cost of your pension; where your contributions come out of your salary before any tax is taken; and where your pension will continue to provide valuable benefits for you and your family if you are too ill to continue to work or die before you retire. Visit Civil Service Pension Scheme for more details.

Generous Annual Leave and Bank Holiday Allowance

25 days annual leave on entry, increasing on a sliding scale to 30 days after 5 years' service (allowance is pro rata for part-time employees). This is in addition to 8 public holidays.

This will be complimented by one further day paid privilege entitlement to mark the King's Birthday.

(Leave is Pro rata basis for part time/job share)

Staff Wellbeing

Flexible working including part-time or term-time working and access to Flexible Working Schemes allowing you to vary your working day as long as you work your total hours.

Generous paid maternity and paternity leave which is notably more than the statutory minimum offered by many other employers.

Childcare benefits (policy for new employees as of 5 April 2018): The government has introduced the Tax-Free Childcare (TFC) scheme. Working parents can open an online childcare account and for every £8 they pay in, the government adds £2, up to a maximum of £2000 a year for each child or £4000 for a disabled child. Parents then use the funds to pay for registered childcare. Existing employees may be able to continue to claim childcare vouchers, so please check how the policy would work for you here. Any move to the DfT from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments.

Onsite facilities Opportunity to use onsite facilities including fitness centres and staff canteens (where applicable).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

Application

To apply for this post, you will need to complete the online form. This should be completed no later than **23:55 on 28th June 2026**.

The application will include:

A **CV** setting out your career history, with key responsibilities and achievements. Please ensure you have provided reasons for any gaps within the last two years.

A Statement of Suitability (no longer than 1000 words) explaining how you consider your personal skills, qualities and experience provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with particular reference to the criteria in the person specification.

Failure to submit both documents will mean the panel only have limited information on which to assess your application against the criteria in the person specification.

As part of the online application process, you will be asked a number of diversity-related questions. If you do not wish to provide a declaration on any of the particular characteristics, you will have the option to select 'prefer not to say'.

All monitoring data will be treated in the strictest confidence and will not be provided to the selection panel.

Should you encounter any issues with your online application please get in touch with us via scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Shortlist

Your application will be acknowledged when it is received.

The panel will select a shortlist of candidates whose applications best demonstrate suitability for the role, by considering the evidence provided against the essential criteria set out in the Person Specification.

Candidates applying under the Disability Confident Scheme who meet the minimum selection criteria in the job specification are guaranteed an interview.

Assessment

Shortlisted candidates may be asked to take part in a series of assessments which could include:

Staff Engagement Exercise - a presentation and Q&A with a representative staff group from across the DfT.

These assessments will not result in a pass or fail decision. Rather, they are designed to support the panel's decision making and highlight areas for the panel to explore further at interview.

Informal Discussions

All shortlisted candidates will have the opportunity to speak with the Job share Sarah Francis prior to the final interview.

Interview

You will be asked to attend a panel interview in order to have a more in-depth discussion of your previous experience and professional competence in relation to the criteria set out in the Person Specification.

The Success Profile Framework will be used to assess and recruit the most suitable candidate. As well as Experience, we will also be using the following four behaviours at the interview stage:

Leadership

Seeing the Big Picture

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Further information about Success Profiles can be found [here](#):

Interviews are expected to take place Via MS Teams, all shortlisted candidates will be asked to prepare a 5 minute presentation.

Offer and Feedback

Unfortunately, due to the anticipated number of applicants for this role, we are unable to provide feedback to those not successful at shortlist stage. Candidates who are shortlisted and attend an interview will be offered verbal feedback from a member of the interview panel.

The timeline later in this pack indicates the date by which decisions are expected to be made, all candidates will be advised of the outcome as soon as possible thereafter, and we will advise on any delays.

Expected Timeline

We will try and offer as much flexibility as we can, but it may not be possible to offer alternative dates for assessments or interviews. You are therefore asked to note the below timetable, exercising flexibility through the recruitment and selection process, in order to meet the dates given. Please note that these dates may be subject to change.

The anticipated timetable is as follows:

Advert Closing Date: **28th June 2026**

Shortlist: **6th July 2026**

Assessments: **13th July 2026**

Panel Interviews: **20th July 2026**

Reasonable Adjustment

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service at:

scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the assistance required section in the personal information page of your application form to provide information we should be aware of that will enable us to support you further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further Information

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact: scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Should candidates like to discuss the role in more detail before submitting an application, please contact: Ben.Smith1@dft.gov.uk

If your application is successful but you have been dismissed from the Civil Service, your application could be removed at the pre-employment checking stage depending on the nature of the dismissal.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment. A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

All external applicants and current employees of accredited non-departmental public bodies (NDPBs) will be required to undergo a Social Media Check. A Social Media Check is a review of your publicly available online activity, typically across platforms like LinkedIn, Facebook, X (formerly

Twitter), Instagram, and others. The purpose is to identify any public posts or content that could raise concerns for employers, such as:

Hate speech or discriminatory behaviour

Threats or acts of violence

Illegal activity or substance misuse

Sexually explicit material

Extremist views or affiliations

Importantly, this check does not involve hacking into your accounts or accessing private messages. It only considers content you have chosen to make public. Employers use this kind of screening to help ensure their workplace remains safe, inclusive, and aligned with company values. It's not about judging your personality or lifestyle - it's about checking for potential red flags that might affect the role or company culture. If you have questions or concerns about the social media check, we would be happy to explain in more detail what's being looked at and how your data is handled securely and fairly.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : SCS Recruitment Team

Email : scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact Government Recruitment Services via email: dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Visit the Civil Service Commission website at <https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk>

